

LIGHT.

The primary zeitgeber — the signal that sets the body's clock.

Light is not only for seeing. It is the main external cue that aligns the internal clock. Morning light tells the system the day has started. Evening light — especially bright, blue-heavy screen light — tells it the day is still going. When those signals are scrambled, sleep, energy, hunger, and mood often scramble with them.

WHAT LIGHT DOES

Bright light in the first hours after waking helps set the clock forward for the day and supports alertness. Dim light and darkness in the evening allow melatonin to rise and sleep pressure to work as intended.

You do not need a laboratory protocol. You need a clearer difference between daytime light and evening light.

PRACTICAL PATTERN

Morning: get outdoor light in the eyes if you can — even on cloudy days. Ten to twenty minutes helps many people.

Day: work near a window when possible.

Evening: lower overhead brightness; reduce bright screens in the last hour before bed.

Contrast is the point. Bright day, dimmer night.

× COMMON FOLLY

- ✗ **Indoor mornings, bright-screen nights.** The clock receives a weak “day” signal and a strong “still daytime” signal at the wrong end. Sleep onset drifts; next-day energy follows.
- ✗ **Only thinking about blue-light glasses.** They can help some people in the evening. They do not replace morning outdoor light or a dimmer wind-down. Sequence matters more than accessories.
- ✗ **Treating light as optional.** Caffeine and alarms can mask a misaligned clock for a while. They do not fix the alignment.

ONE-WEEK EXPERIMENT

Outdoor light within an hour of waking most days. Dimmer lights and fewer bright screens in the last hour at night. Keep wake time steady.

Notice sleep onset, morning alertness, and afternoon flatness. Many people feel the difference before they believe the mechanism.

TIED TO THE PROGRAMME

Circadian biology sits inside Going Deeper for a reason. Light is the lever most people can pull without buying anything. Use it before you complicate the stack.

Next step: Morning outdoor light + dimmer last hour for seven days. Free programme at beinghaware.github.io/BHAFL.